# Gold — Week Ahead

*23 August 2026 to 30 August*

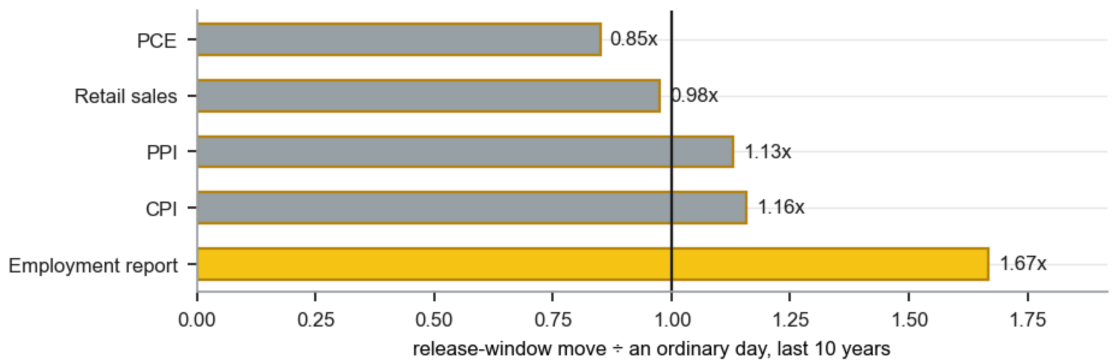
What is scheduled, how gold has behaved around those releases historically, and what a given move in rates or the dollar would be worth. **This report does not forecast the gold price** — see the methodology note overleaf.

| EXPLAINED BY DRIVERS | UNEXPLAINED BAND | GOLD VS DRIVERS, 12M |
|---|---|---|
| **28%** | **±4.1%** | **+15.2%** |
| of a typical one-month move | 1 s.d. of what drivers miss | 82th percentile of that gap |

## 1 Scheduled this week

| Day | Time | | Release | Consensus | Previous | Gold's typical reaction |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Tue 25 Aug | 21:30 ET | AUD | CPI m/m | 0.9% | -0.1% | — |
| Tue 25 Aug | 21:30 ET | AUD | CPI y/y | 3.3% | 3.8% | — |
| Tue 25 Aug | 21:30 ET | AUD | Trimmed Mean CPI m/m | 0.3% | 0.3% | — |
| Wed 26 Aug | 08:30 ET | USD | **Core PCE Price Index m/m** | 0.2% | 0.1% | no measurable premium |
| Wed 26 Aug | 08:30 ET | USD | Prelim GDP q/q | 1.5% | 1.5% | — |
| Fri 28 Aug | 08:30 ET | CAD | GDP m/m | 0.2% | 0.3% | — |
| Fri 28 Aug | 10:00 ET | USD | Fed Chairman Warsh Speaks | — | — | — |
| Fri 28 Aug | 10:00 ET | USD | Prelim Benchmark Payrolls Revision | — | -911K | — |
| Fri 28 Aug | 12:15 ET | All | Jackson Hole Symposium | — | — | — |

## 2 What the record actually shows




| Release | Last 10y | 0-5 | 5-10 | 10-15 | 15-20 | 20-25 | 25-30 | 30-35 | Verdict |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Employment report** | **1.67×** | 1.53 | 1.56 | 2.09 | 1.36 | 1.34 | 1.20 | 1.04 | **elevated in every period** |
| CPI | 1.16× | 1.30 | 1.02 | 1.00 | 1.10 | 1.24 | 0.90 | 0.98 | no consistent premium |
| PPI | 1.13× | 1.05 | 1.27 | — | — | — | — | — | too short to judge |
| Retail sales | 0.98× | 0.92 | 1.07 | 0.92 | 1.02 | 0.97 | — | — | no consistent premium |
| PCE | 0.85× | 0.95 | 0.83 | 1.19 | 0.97 | 1.13 | — | — | no consistent premium |

Gold's average absolute move in the release window (London AM to PM fix, which brackets the 08:30 ET print) divided by the same figure on ordinary days matched for year and weekday. Columns are **equal-width, non-overlapping five-**

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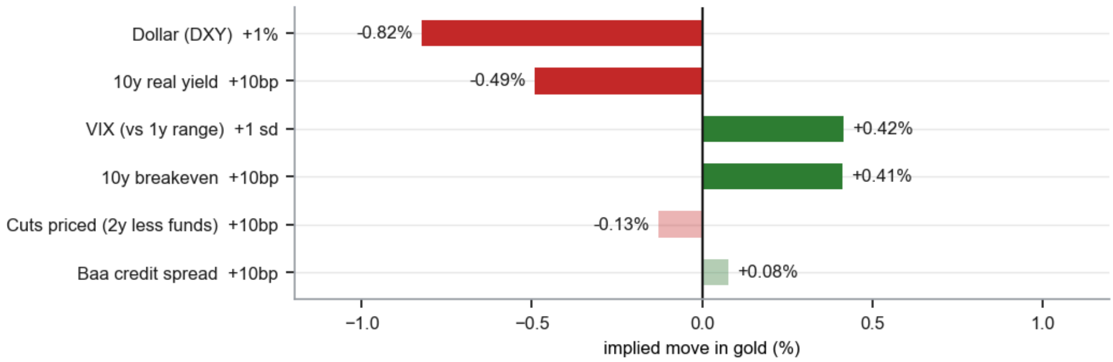
**year periods counting back from today** — so the leftmost describes the market you are trading now, and each is an independent sample rather than a rolling window of largely the same data.

**Read the row, not the number.** A relationship that is real barely moves when the period changes; one that wanders was never established, however convincing a single cut looks. The **employment report** sits above 1.0 in all seven periods and is the only release whose premium survives a multiple-comparison correction across the five tested here. **CPI runs between 0.90 and 1.30 with no pattern** and every confidence interval containing 1.0 — quoted alone its recent reading looks like a premium, and across the full record it does not hold up. PCE and retail sales show nothing in any period. PPI has usable history only from 2011, which is too little to judge either way.

# 3 What each driver is worth




| Driver | Move | Implied gold | t |
|---|---|---|---|
| Dollar (DXY) | +1% | -0.82% | -7.6 |
| 10y real yield | +10bp | -0.49% | -4.5 |
| VIX (vs 1y range) | +1 sd | +0.42% | 2.3 |
| 10y breakeven | +10bp | +0.41% | 2.4 |
| Cuts priced (2y less funds) | +10bp | -0.13% | -1.7 |
| Baa credit spread | +10bp | +0.08% | 0.5 |

Fitted jointly on 6,146 daily observations of point-in-time data, with Newey-West standard errors at the one-month horizon. Faded bars in the chart are coefficients that do not clear |t| = 2 and should be read as noise.

# 4 Scenarios

| Scenario | Assumes | Implied gold |
|---|---|---|
| **Dovish** | Real yields −20bp, dollar −2%, breakevens +10bp | **+3.1% ±4.1%** |
| **Hawkish** | Real yields +25bp, dollar +2% | **-2.8% ±4.1%** |
| **Risk-off** | VIX +1sd, credit +50bp, real yields −15bp, dollar +1% | **+0.7% ±4.1%** |

Each scenario states its own assumptions; every driver not named is held unchanged rather than set to a historical average. The band is one standard deviation of the move the drivers do *not* explain, and it is wide — larger than most of the scenario effects themselves.

# 5 The month just gone

Gold moved **+13.28%** over the last 21 trading days. The drivers account for **+3.49%**; the remaining **+9.47%** is not explained by rates, the dollar, credit or risk appetite. Over twelve months that unexplained component now stands at **+15.2%** — the portion of gold's run that the measurable macro drivers do not account for, and the usual candidates for it are official-sector buying and the debasement trade, neither of which this report attempts to quantify.

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# Methodology

*and what this report does not claim*

**This report contains no forecast of the gold price.** The underlying research tested whether the standard gold drivers — real yields, the dollar, Fed pricing, ETF flows, positioning, official-sector demand and Asian physical premia — can predict gold's direction over 5, 60 and 250 days. Across 21 years, using point-in-time data with no look-ahead, **they cannot**. Every driver that shows a statistically robust relationship with gold moves *at the same time* as gold, not before it, in every volatility and trend regime tested. No model built in that work beat simply holding the metal. What follows is therefore a description of measured relationships and historical behaviour only.

**Gold benchmark.** LBMA Gold Price PM, USD/oz, the London auction print. A fix is a single auction, not a continuous tradeable price.

**Baseline.** Ordinary days matched on year and weekday, so a Friday release is compared with other Fridays from the same era.

**Sensitivities.** Ridge on same-period driver changes; the penalty keeps the collinear rates and dollar block readable. Newey-West errors at one month.

**Point-in-time.** Every input is read as it stood on the day, including the revision then in force. Macro series carry their true first-release dates.

**Release window.** London AM to PM fix, which brackets the 08:30 ET release. The 24-hour fix-to-fix measure is weaker and is not shown.

**Significance.** Stratified permutation test with Holm correction across event types. Absolute returns are not normal, so a t-test would not do.

**Exogenous drivers only.** ETF tonnage and positioning are excluded — they rise *because* gold rallied as much as the reverse, and including them halves the measured real-yield effect.

**Surprise, not measured.** No free source carries a history of consensus forecasts, so only the *fact* of a release is known, never whether it surprised. Nothing here conditions on the size or sign of a surprise.

Sources: LBMA (benchmark), FRED and ALFRED (rates, inflation, credit, activity — with full revision history), Yahoo Finance (dollar index, equities), CFTC (positioning), SPDR Gold Trust (ETF tonnage), IMF (official reserves), Shanghai Gold Exchange (Asian premium), FairEconomy (calendar). Built 2026-08-23.



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